

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 4

Chapter 9: From the Rulers to the Ruled: Types of Governments

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	9 — From the Rulers to the Ruled: Types of Governments
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. A king need not block democracy (constitutional monarchy = parliamentary democracy); India is parliamentary despite having a President because real power sits with the PM and Council of Ministers; elections alone never equal democracy (equality, rights, rule of law and an independent judiciary are also required); democracy and republic are not synonyms; and a winning majority can never vote away anyone's fundamental rights. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A country abolishes its hereditary throne and, from then on, elects a head of state for a fixed term, yet it still lets only a tiny landowning elite vote and silences all critics. Using only the textbook definitions, which single label is now unquestionably accurate?

- (A) Republic, because the head of state is elected rather than inheriting the office
- (B) Democracy, because abolishing the throne automatically establishes rule by the people
- (C) Constitutional monarchy, because it retains an elected head of state in place of a king
- (D) Direct democracy, because the citizens themselves now choose the head of state

2. Which statement most precisely captures the relationship between 'democracy' and 'republic'?

- (A) They are exact synonyms, so every democracy is a republic and every republic is a democracy
- (B) A republic is a kind of monarchy in which the king is chosen by the people for a fixed term
- (C) Democracy describes an elected head of state, while a republic describes rule by the whole people
- (D) They overlap but are not identical: democracy concerns who rules (the people), while a republic specifies that the head of state is elected, not hereditary

3. Four labels are proposed for the same country, which is governed by clerics applying sacred religious law. Which label is the odd one out because it does NOT fit that description?

- (A) Oligarchy
- (B) Theocracy
- (C) A government where religious leaders hold authority
- (D) A state where sacred law overrides ordinary lawmaking

4. A single ruler holds power that no constitution, court or election can limit, having seized it rather than inherited it. Which classification fits best, and why is 'monarchy' wrong here?

- (A) Monarchy, because any single all-powerful ruler is automatically a monarch
- (B) Dictatorship, because one person holds absolute, unchecked power, and monarchy is wrong because monarchy means power inherited within a family, not seized and unlimited
- (C) Theocracy, because unchecked power must rest on a religious claim
- (D) Oligarchy, because absolute power always belongs to a group rather than one person

5. Two countries each concentrate power away from the broad public. In the first, five wealthy families jointly run the state; in the second, one general rules alone without limits. These two are, respectively:

- (A) An oligarchy and a dictatorship
- (B) A dictatorship and an oligarchy
- (C) A republic and a constitutional monarchy
- (D) A theocracy and a direct democracy

6. Which option lists three forms of government that all concentrate power in a small number of rulers rather than spreading it among the people?

- (A) Representative democracy, direct democracy, republic
- (B) Direct democracy, oligarchy, constitutional monarchy
- (C) Absolute monarchy, dictatorship, oligarchy
- (D) Republic, theocracy, representative democracy

7. Greek roots help decode these words. Which pairing of word and its root meaning is correct?

(A) Oligarchy: 'few' + 'rule'

(B) Monarchy: 'many' + 'rule'

(C) Democracy: 'god' + 'power'

(D) Theocracy: 'one' + 'rule'

8. A debater claims, 'Because a dictatorship has a single decisive ruler, it is simply the fastest kind of democracy.' What is the strongest correction?

(A) The claim is correct, since speed of decision is the main thing that defines a democracy

(B) A dictatorship is not a democracy at all, fast or slow, because its ruler holds unchecked power and is not accountable to the people who cannot remove him

(C) A dictatorship is a democracy, but only when the dictator also wins an election

(D) A dictatorship is a constitutional monarchy, so the word 'democracy' simply does not apply

9. In an absolute monarchy and a dictatorship, the deepest similarity is that:

(A) Both choose their ruler through universal adult franchise

(B) Both keep the ruler's power purely ceremonial while an elected body governs

(C) Both require the ruler to step down whenever a court rules against him

(D) One person holds power with no genuine accountability to the people or limits from law

10. Which statement about an oligarchy is accurate?

(A) Every adult citizen votes directly on each major law

(B) A small powerful group, often wealthy, makes the key decisions, so power rests with the few rather than the people

(C) A hereditary monarch holds all authority and passes it to a child

(D) Religious leaders govern strictly according to sacred scripture

11. A country calls itself a 'people's democracy', holds a vote every five years, but only one party is ever allowed on the ballot, the courts obey that party, and criticising leaders is a crime. The most accurate classification is:

(A) A genuine democracy, because it holds a vote on a fixed five-year schedule

(B) A dictatorship dressed in democratic language, because real power is unchecked and the people cannot genuinely choose or remove their rulers

(C) A republic, and therefore necessarily a full democracy as well

(D) A direct democracy, because the people cast votes themselves

12. Which feature, if newly introduced, would move a country FURTHER from democracy rather than toward it?

(A) Extending the right to vote to every adult citizen

(B) Guaranteeing citizens the freedom to criticise the government

(C) Allowing an independent court to overturn unlawful government actions

(D) Placing all courts under the direct command of the ruling party

13. A national parliament debates and then passes a new tax law. By contrast, a small village calls every resident together and they personally vote yes or no on repairing the village well. These two decisions illustrate, respectively:

- (A) Direct democracy and representative democracy
- (B) Oligarchy and constitutional monarchy
- (C) A referendum and a parliamentary election
- (D) Representative democracy and direct democracy

14. Why do almost all large modern democracies rely on representatives rather than having citizens decide every law directly?

- (A) International law forbids direct democracy in any country above a certain size
- (B) Citizens of large countries are legally barred from holding political opinions
- (C) It is impractical for millions of people to assemble and vote on every single decision, so they elect representatives to decide for them
- (D) Representatives in large countries are hereditary monarchs who decide by birthright

15. A referendum and the election of a member of parliament are both votes, yet they differ because in a referendum:

- (A) Only members of the existing parliament are permitted to cast votes
- (B) A panel of judges casts the deciding ballots on the citizens' behalf
- (C) A monarch announces the result after privately consulting the nobility
- (D) Citizens decide a specific question themselves rather than choosing a person to decide for them

16. A class no longer lets all forty students vote on every decision; instead it elects three monitors to decide on the class's behalf, and the monitors must report back. This shift is most analogous to a move from:

- (A) Representative democracy to direct democracy
- (B) Democracy to monarchy
- (C) Direct democracy to representative democracy
- (D) Oligarchy to dictatorship

17. A 'representative' in a democracy is best defined as:

- (A) The wealthiest individual in the community, who therefore decides for all
- (B) A ruler who holds office because of the family into which he was born
- (C) A person chosen by others to make decisions on their behalf and answerable to them
- (D) A judge appointed to interpret laws and settle legal disputes

18. Which scenario is the clearest example of direct democracy in action?

- (A) A town council that the residents elected votes on whether to ban traffic
- (B) A mayor who inherited the office decrees that traffic is banned

- (C) A national parliament passes a transport budget covering many towns
- (D) All the residents of a small town personally vote in a town meeting on whether to ban traffic from the main square

19. In a direct democracy and a representative democracy, the common thread that still makes both 'democracies' is that:

- (A) Ultimate power rests with the people, whether they decide issues themselves or through chosen representatives
- (B) Both vest ultimate power in a hereditary monarch who reigns for life
- (C) Both forbid citizens from voting and leave all decisions to appointed officials
- (D) Both require that all decisions be approved by religious leaders first

20. Universal adult franchise is described as a pillar of democracy because it ensures that:

- (A) Only citizens who own enough land are entitled to cast a vote
- (B) Every citizen above a set age may vote, regardless of wealth, gender or property
- (C) Only one gender is permitted to take part in elections
- (D) Only serving members of the government may vote in elections

21. Assertion: In a democracy a winning majority may pass any law it likes, including one that removes a minority's fundamental rights. Reason: Democracy means majority rule. Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both the assertion and the reason are fully true, and the reason explains the assertion
- (B) Both are false, because democracy involves no majority decisions at all
- (C) The assertion is true, but the reason is false because democracy never involves the majority
- (D) The assertion is false, while the reason is partly true but incomplete; democracy is majority rule limited by protected rights, so a majority cannot vote away fundamental rights

22. Which situation most strongly shows that merely holding an election does not by itself make a country a democracy?

- (A) Votes are held, and opposition parties campaign freely and sometimes win
- (B) Votes are held, and independent courts can overturn unlawful government actions
- (C) Votes are held, but critics are jailed and the courts always side with the rulers
- (D) Votes are held, and minorities enjoy the same legal rights as the majority

23. Which statement about 'rule of law' in a democracy is correct?

- (A) Leaders stand above the law and cannot be questioned for their actions
- (B) Only ordinary citizens must obey the law, while rulers are exempt
- (C) Even the government and its leaders are bound by the law, just as ordinary citizens are
- (D) The law applies to everyone, but only during election years

- 24.** An independent judiciary strengthens democracy chiefly because it can:
- (A) Always rule in the ruling party's favour to maintain stability
 - (B) Decide cases fairly even against the government, upholding laws and rights
 - (C) Follow the head of government's instructions on how to decide each case
 - (D) Offer only non-binding advice to a hereditary king
- 25.** Why must democratic elections be 'free and fair', not merely held on schedule?
- (A) Because elections are only a formality with no real bearing on who holds power
 - (B) Because only the ruling party should be permitted to contest them
 - (C) Because the winner ought to be decided in advance by the current rulers
 - (D) If voters are intimidated or results are rigged, the vote no longer reflects the people's genuine choice
- 26.** Which single feature, present in a genuine democracy, is reliably ABSENT in a dictatorship?
- (A) A capital city from which the government operates
 - (B) Armed forces that defend the country's borders
 - (C) A national flag and a national anthem
 - (D) Genuine accountability of rulers to the people, who can replace them through free elections
- 27.** A constitution guarantees free speech and equality, and an independent court can enforce these even against the government, but ordinary citizens never actually decide policy and no elections are held. Which pillar of democracy is most clearly still MISSING?
- (A) Protection of fundamental rights such as free speech
 - (B) An independent judiciary able to check the government
 - (C) Free and fair elections through which the people choose and can remove their rulers
 - (D) Equality of citizens before the law
- 28.** Which of the following best explains why 'democracy' means more than simple majority rule?
- (A) Alongside majority decisions, it protects the rights of minorities and individuals through a constitution and limits on power
 - (B) Because the majority is entitled to override any right whenever it wishes
 - (C) Because only the minority is ever permitted to make the final decision
 - (D) Because there are no rules at all that limit what any group may do
- 29.** 'Accountability' in a democracy is best understood as the principle that the government is:
- (A) Free from any questioning by the citizens it governs
 - (B) Answerable to the people who elected it and removable by them through elections
 - (C) Answerable only to a foreign power rather than its own people
 - (D) Entitled to overrule the courts whenever it disagrees with them

30. Equality of citizens is treated as a core democratic principle mainly because it ensures that:

- (A) Wealthier citizens are given extra votes in proportion to their property
- (B) Only citizens of one religion are recognised as full members of the state
- (C) Every citizen counts the same before the law and in choosing the government, regardless of wealth or birth
- (D) Decisions are reserved for a small group of the most powerful families

31. A government claims, 'We won the most votes, so the law no longer applies to us.' The strongest constitutional response is:

- (A) A winning majority indeed frees leaders from any legal limits
- (B) Only the courts, never the constitution, can ever limit elected leaders
- (C) Winning a majority does not place leaders above the law; rule of law and the constitution bind even an elected government
- (D) An electoral victory automatically suspends fundamental rights

32. Which set of features, taken together, most reliably marks a country as a genuine democracy?

- (A) A large army, a long history, and a single long-ruling family
- (B) Regular votes only, with no protected rights and no independent courts
- (C) Free and fair elections, equality before the law, protected fundamental rights, and an independent judiciary
- (D) Rule by religious law alone, with leaders chosen by the clergy

33. A queen formally signs every law and opens parliament each year, but an elected parliament debates, decides and is answerable for those laws. Her country is best classified as:

- (A) An absolute monarchy, because the queen signs every law
- (B) A dictatorship, because one person sits at the top of the state
- (C) A theocracy, because the queen is treated with ceremonial reverence
- (D) A constitutional monarchy that is also a parliamentary democracy

34. Assertion: A country can be both a monarchy and a democracy at the same time.
Reason: In a constitutional monarchy the monarch's powers are largely nominal while an elected parliament governs. Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason correctly explains the assertion
- (B) Both are true, but the reason does not explain the assertion
- (C) The assertion is true but the reason is false
- (D) The assertion is false but the reason is true

35. Saudi Arabia and the United Kingdom are both monarchies, yet only one is also a democracy. The best explanation is:

- (A) Saudi Arabia is an absolute monarchy where the king actually governs, while the UK is a constitutional monarchy where an elected parliament governs under a nominal king
- (B) Both kings rule absolutely, so neither country is a democracy
- (C) Both are democracies simply because each has a monarch
- (D) The UK is a democracy because its monarch is elected, while Saudi Arabia's is not

36. The crucial difference between an absolute monarchy and a constitutional monarchy is that:

- (A) In both, the monarch is purely ceremonial and an elected body governs
- (B) In an absolute monarchy the monarch truly holds and exercises ruling power, while in a constitutional monarchy the monarch is largely nominal and an elected body governs
- (C) In an absolute monarchy the king is elected, while in a constitutional monarchy he inherits the throne
- (D) In a constitutional monarchy the king personally makes every law, while in an absolute monarchy he has no power

37. A king issues laws himself, commands the army, and personally judges disputes, with no elected body able to overrule him. This scenario fits which form, and why not the alternative?

- (A) Constitutional monarchy, because any country with a king is constitutional by definition
- (B) Republic, because the king makes the final decisions on laws
- (C) Direct democracy, because the king decides matters quickly and personally
- (D) Absolute monarchy, because the king actually exercises all power; not a constitutional monarchy, where the monarch would be nominal and an elected parliament would govern

38. Which traditional claim is most directly disproved by the existence of countries like the UK?

- (A) The claim that any country with a king or queen cannot be a democracy
- (B) The claim that monarchs inherit rather than win their position
- (C) The claim that parliaments are able to make laws
- (D) The claim that democracies ever hold elections

39. In which form of government is power most clearly passed down within a single family by birth?

- (A) Republic
- (B) Representative democracy
- (C) Oligarchy
- (D) Monarchy

40. Why is it accurate to say the UK is a democracy even though it has never elected its monarch?

- (A) Because the monarch is secretly elected by the people each term
- (B) The monarch's role is nominal, and the country is actually governed by a parliament that the people elect
- (C) Because the monarch personally makes all the laws after winning a vote
- (D) Because simply having any monarch automatically makes a country democratic

41. Compare a republic with a constitutional monarchy. Both can be democracies, but they differ in that:

- (A) A republic keeps a hereditary king while a constitutional monarchy elects its head of state
- (B) Only a constitutional monarchy can ever be a democracy
- (C) A republic has an elected head of state, while a constitutional monarchy keeps a hereditary monarch as a nominal head
- (D) Neither a republic nor a constitutional monarchy can hold elections of any kind

42. The three organs of government are correctly matched to their core functions in which option?

- (A) Legislature makes laws; executive carries them out; judiciary settles disputes and ensures laws are followed
- (B) Legislature carries out laws; executive settles disputes; judiciary makes laws
- (C) Legislature settles disputes; executive makes laws; judiciary carries them out
- (D) Legislature, executive and judiciary all only make laws

43. A court strikes down a government order because it breaks the law. Which function of government is at work, and why not the executive?

- (A) The judicial function, because interpreting law and judging whether an act is lawful is judicial; the executive's job is to carry out laws, not to judge them
- (B) The legislative function, because the court is effectively writing a new law
- (C) The executive function, because the court is enforcing the government's will
- (D) A ceremonial function, because striking down an order is a symbolic act

44. Debating and then passing a brand-new law is which function of government?

- (A) The executive function
- (B) The legislative function
- (C) The judicial function
- (D) The electoral function

45. 'Separation of powers' protects democracy mainly because it:

- (A) Lets the executive take charge of the courts so decisions come faster
- (B) Concentrates all authority in the legislature for the sake of efficiency
- (C) Removes the need for any laws by letting the organs act on their own judgement
- (D) Stops any single organ of government from gaining total control and abusing power

46. A new country wants to ensure that no single leader can dominate the state. Which design choice best serves that goal?

- (A) Letting one elected leader also appoint all the judges and control lawmaking
- (B) Dividing power among an independent legislature, executive and judiciary so each checks the others
- (C) Abolishing the courts so that decisions can be made more quickly
- (D) Giving the army authority over both the legislature and the judiciary

47. If one ruler personally controls the lawmakers, the enforcers and the judges all at once, the principle most clearly absent is:

- (A) The country's possession of a national flag
- (B) Separation of powers
- (C) The country's having a large population
- (D) The country's having rivers and mountains

48. Which statement about the three organs of government is correct?

- (A) Each organ is an entirely separate country with its own citizens
- (B) The judiciary makes the laws while the legislature judges disputes
- (C) Even though they are separate, the three organs together run the same single state and must function within the law
- (D) Only the executive is part of the government; the other two are private bodies

49. In a parliamentary system such as India and a presidential system such as the USA, the key contrast about the head of government is that:

- (A) In the parliamentary system the head of government comes from the legislature and must keep its confidence, while in the presidential system the head is separately elected and independent of the legislature
- (B) In both, the head of government is a hereditary monarch chosen at birth
- (C) In the parliamentary system the head is separately elected, while in the presidential system the head comes from the legislature
- (D) In both systems the courts appoint the head of government

50. India has a President, yet it is called a parliamentary democracy rather than a presidential one. The best explanation is that:

- (A) India's President personally governs the country and is therefore the head of government
- (B) Real executive power rests with the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers, who must keep the legislature's confidence, while the President is largely nominal
- (C) Any country that has both a President and a Prime Minister is automatically presidential
- (D) The President of India is directly elected by all voters, which makes the system presidential

51. If India's Lok Sabha passes a vote of no confidence in the government, the most accurate consequence is that:

- (A) Nothing changes, because the Prime Minister is elected separately for a fixed term
- (B) The President is automatically removed from office along with the government
- (C) The Council of Ministers headed by the Prime Minister must resign, showing the executive depends on the legislature's confidence
- (D) The Supreme Court must dissolve itself and then elect a new government

52. Two democracies are compared. In the first, the head of government can be removed mid-term if the legislature withdraws its confidence; in the second, the separately elected head serves a fixed term regardless of the legislature. These are, respectively:

- (A) A presidential system and a parliamentary system
- (B) An absolute monarchy and a constitutional monarchy
- (C) A theocracy and an oligarchy
- (D) A parliamentary system and a presidential system

53. A student says, 'India copied the US, so India's President runs the country just like the US President.' The most accurate correction is:

- (A) The student is right, because both Presidents are the real heads of government
- (B) Unlike the US President, India's President is largely nominal, and the country is run by the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers answerable to Parliament
- (C) India has no Prime Minister, so its President must run everything alone
- (D) India's President, like the US President, is directly elected by all voters and rules independently

54. In a parliamentary democracy, the relationship between the executive and the legislature is best described as:

- (A) The executive is drawn from the legislature and stays in office only while it holds the legislature's confidence
- (B) The executive is elected entirely separately and cannot be removed by the legislature mid-term
- (C) The executive and the legislature are the same single person
- (D) The executive controls the legislature and can abolish it at will

55. Despite acknowledging its flaws, the chapter concludes that democracy is:

- (A) The rarest form of government found on Earth
- (B) A system that no country actually puts into practice
- (C) Identical in practice to a dictatorship
- (D) The most popular form of government in the world today

56. The chapter's 'Peek into History' examples, including the Vajji, ancient Greece and Rome, are meant to show that:

- (A) Democracy was invented entirely in the twenty-first century
- (B) Only one civilisation in all of history ever attempted any self-rule

(C) The idea of the ruled choosing their rulers is ancient and arose in several civilisations, not only in modern times

(D) Holding elections was impossible before the modern age

57. The Lichchhavi clan, an early Indian example of people choosing their leaders, belonged to which confederation, and what does this illustrate?

(A) The Magadha empire of the Mauryas, a monarchy of inherited kings

(B) The Chola kingdom of the south, linked to the Uttaramerur election records

(C) The Vajji, illustrating that choosing leaders rather than simply inheriting power existed in ancient India

(D) The Kushana empire of the northwest, ruled by foreign conquerors

58. The Uttaramerur inscriptions are historically valuable mainly because they show that:

(A) India held no elections of any kind before modern times

(B) Organised elections to choose local representatives existed in early India

(C) Only hereditary kings ever held power throughout Indian history

(D) Elections were a practice found only in ancient Greece

59. The chapter says every country has a government, yet governments are not all alike. The deepest question that distinguishes one type from another is:

(A) Who holds power and how the government is chosen and held answerable

(B) Which country has the largest land area

(C) Which country possesses the biggest army (D) Which country is the oldest in history

60. Country P holds free elections, lets courts rule against the government and protects critics; Country Q holds elections too, but one party controls the judges, jails critics and bans rival parties. Which is more accurately a democracy, and why?

(A) Country P, because democracy needs not just elections but also rule of law, an independent judiciary and protected freedoms

(B) Country Q, because holding regular elections is by itself the complete test of democracy

(C) Both equally, because each country holds elections

(D) Neither, because true democracy forbids organised political parties altogether

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 9: From the Rulers to the Ruled: Types of Governments — Paper 4

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, -1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	A	11	B	21	D	31	C	41	C	51	C
2	D	12	D	22	C	32	C	42	A	52	D
3	A	13	D	23	C	33	D	43	A	53	B
4	B	14	C	24	B	34	A	44	B	54	A
5	A	15	D	25	D	35	A	45	D	55	D
6	C	16	C	26	D	36	B	46	B	56	C
7	A	17	C	27	C	37	D	47	B	57	C
8	B	18	D	28	A	38	A	48	C	58	B
9	D	19	A	29	B	39	D	49	A	59	A
10	B	20	B	30	C	40	B	50	B	60	A

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (A) A republic is defined narrowly by one feature: the head of state is elected, not hereditary. Abolishing the throne and electing the head meets exactly that test, so 'republic' is the only certain label. It is not a democracy, because rule by the people requires equality, broad franchise and protected freedoms, all of which are denied here when only a landowning elite votes and critics are silenced. It cannot be a constitutional monarchy, because that form by definition keeps a hereditary monarch as nominal head, which this country has just removed. And it is not a direct democracy, since the people are electing a head of state (a representative act), not personally deciding every issue themselves.

2. (D) The terms answer different questions. 'Democracy' is about where ultimate power lies (with the people), whereas 'republic' fixes one structural point: the head of state is elected, never inherited. A country can be one without fully being the other, so they

overlap but are not identical. They are therefore not exact synonyms. A republic is not a type of monarchy; a monarchy by definition has a hereditary ruler, which a republic specifically excludes. And the last option simply swaps the two definitions, attaching the elected-head meaning to 'democracy' and the rule-by-people meaning to 'republic', which inverts the truth.

3. (A) Rule by clerics under sacred law is a theocracy, defined precisely by religion being the basis of authority. The odd one out is 'oligarchy', which means rule by a small powerful group (often the wealthy) and is defined by the number of rulers and their economic position, not by religion. 'A government where religious leaders hold authority' simply restates theocracy. So does 'a state where sacred law overrides ordinary lawmaking', since rule by religious law is the theocratic feature. Only oligarchy misdescribes a clergy-run, sacred-law state.

4. (B) Unchecked power in the hands of one person who took it rather than inheriting it is a dictatorship. Monarchy is wrong precisely because a monarch's defining trait is hereditary succession within a family, which this ruler lacks. It is not a theocracy, because nothing here ties the rule to religion or sacred law. And it is not an oligarchy, because oligarchy means rule by a small group, whereas this is one individual, so dictatorship is the only correct fit.

5. (A) Rule by a small powerful group, such as five wealthy families, is an oligarchy, while unchecked rule by one person is a dictatorship, so the correct order is oligarchy then dictatorship. The first distractor reverses the pair, mislabelling the five-family rule as a dictatorship and the lone general as an oligarchy. A republic and a constitutional monarchy both involve elected or law-bound governance, which neither concentrated case describes. And theocracy (religious rule) and direct democracy (people deciding directly) match neither scenario.

6. (C) Absolute monarchy (one ruling king), dictatorship (one unchecked ruler) and oligarchy (a small ruling group) all keep power in a few hands rather than with the people, so this set is correct. Representative democracy, direct democracy and the republic all locate power with the people, so that set is the opposite. The third option mixes in direct democracy and a constitutional monarchy, both of which spread or limit power. And the last option includes the republic and representative democracy, which again rest power with the people, so only the first list is uniformly few-ruler.

7. (A) 'Oligarchy' joins the roots for 'few' and 'rule', matching its meaning of rule by a small group. 'Monarchy' comes from 'one' (mono) and 'rule', not 'many', so that pairing is wrong. 'Democracy' joins 'people' (demos) and 'power' (kratos), not 'god' and 'power'. And 'theocracy' joins 'god' (theos) and 'power/rule', not 'one' and 'rule', so only the oligarchy pairing is accurate.

8. (B) Democracy is defined by power resting with the people and rulers being accountable and removable, none of which a dictatorship allows; its ruler holds unchecked power, so it is not a democracy of any speed. Speed of decision does not define democracy, so the claim is not correct. Winning an election does not convert unchecked, unaccountable rule into democracy, since the other pillars (rights, rule of law, removability) are still missing. And a dictatorship is not a constitutional monarchy, which features a nominal monarch over an elected parliament, so that label is simply mistaken.

9. (D) Both forms place near-total power in a single ruler who is not truly answerable to the people or limited by law, which is their core resemblance. Neither selects its ruler by universal adult franchise; an absolute monarch inherits and a dictator seizes power. Neither keeps the ruler ceremonial; that describes a constitutional monarchy, the opposite arrangement. And in neither does a court's ruling force the ruler out, precisely because both lack the independent checks that would make that possible.

10. (B) Oligarchy means rule by a few, typically a small wealthy clique that controls the important decisions, so power lies with the few rather than the broad public. Every adult voting directly on laws describes a direct democracy, the opposite of oligarchy. A hereditary monarch holding and passing on all authority is a monarchy, which concentrates power in one inherited line, not a group. And rule by religious leaders under scripture is a theocracy, defined by religion rather than by a powerful clique.

11. (B) When only one party may stand, the courts serve that party, and criticism is criminalised, the vote is a hollow ritual; power is unchecked and the people cannot truly choose or remove rulers, which is dictatorship behind democratic wording. A fixed voting schedule does not make a genuine democracy, since free choice and the other pillars are absent. Even if its head of state were elected, being a republic does not guarantee full democracy, because rights, free competition and independent courts are still missing. And it is not a direct democracy; casting a managed ballot for one permitted party is not the people deciding issues freely.

12. (D) Subordinating the courts to the ruling party destroys judicial independence, a key democratic pillar, so it moves the country away from democracy. Extending the vote to every adult is universal adult franchise, a core democratic gain. Guaranteeing free criticism protects freedom of speech, again strengthening democracy. And letting an independent court overturn unlawful government acts reinforces rule of law, so only party control of the courts is anti-democratic.

13. (D) Elected members deciding in parliament is representative democracy, while residents personally voting on the well is direct democracy, so the order is representative then direct. The first distractor reverses the two. Neither case is oligarchy (rule by a few) or constitutional monarchy (a nominal king over parliament). And while the village vote resembles a referendum, the parliament's tax law is not a 'parliamentary election'; the option mislabels a lawmaking act as the election of members.

14. (C) Scale is the practical reason: with millions of citizens it is unworkable for everyone to gather and vote on each decision, so they elect representatives to act for them. There is no international law banning direct democracy by size; small communities and referendums still use direct methods. Citizens are certainly allowed political opinions; that is fundamental to democracy. And representatives are elected, not hereditary monarchs, which is precisely what keeps the system democratic.

15. (D) A referendum is direct democracy: the people themselves settle one particular question by voting on it, instead of electing someone to decide later. It is not limited to sitting members of parliament; the whole electorate votes. Judges do not cast the deciding ballots; that would defeat the point of a popular vote. And a monarch announcing a result after consulting nobles is monarchy, not a citizen-decided referendum.

16. (C) Everyone voting on everything is like direct democracy; electing a few monitors to decide and answer back is like representative democracy, so the shift runs from direct to representative. The reverse ordering is therefore wrong. It is not a move to monarchy, because the monitors are elected and accountable, not hereditary rulers. And it is neither oligarchy nor dictatorship, since the monitors are chosen by the class and must report back, which are democratic features absent in those forms.

17. (C) A representative is someone the people select to decide for them and to whom they remain accountable, which is the basis of representative democracy. The wealthiest person has no representative role merely from being rich. Holding office by birth describes a hereditary monarch, not an elected representative. And a judge interpreting law performs a judicial function, distinct from representing voters in decision-making.

18. (D) Direct democracy is the people themselves deciding an issue, exactly as when all residents vote in person on the traffic ban. The elected council deciding is representative democracy, since chosen agents decide. A mayor who inherited office and decrees alone is a hereditary, monarchical act, not democracy of either kind. And a parliament passing a budget is again representative democracy, because elected members, not the people directly, take the decision.

19. (A) What makes both democracies is that power flows from the people, whether they decide directly or elect representatives to decide for them. Neither vests power in a hereditary monarch; that would be a monarchy. Neither forbids citizens from voting; voting is central to both. And neither requires religious approval of decisions, which would make them theocracies rather than democracies.

20. (B) Universal adult franchise means the vote belongs to every citizen over a certain age, irrespective of wealth, gender or property, embodying equality. Limiting the vote to landowners contradicts the word 'universal'. Restricting it to one gender denies the equality the franchise guarantees. And confining the vote to government members would create a tiny ruling clique, the very opposite of broad popular participation.

21. (D) The assertion is false: a constitution and protected fundamental rights stop even a majority from stripping a minority's rights. The reason that 'democracy means majority rule' is only partly right and incomplete, because democracy is majority rule tempered by guaranteed rights and limits on power. So the assertion is false while the reason is incomplete, not a sound explanation. Both are not fully true, since the assertion contradicts rights protection. They are not both false, because democracy clearly does involve majority decisions. And the assertion is not true with a false reason, because the assertion itself is wrong.

22. (C) An election alongside jailed critics and captured courts shows a vote stripped of free speech and judicial independence, so it is not a genuine democracy despite the voting. The other three describe elections accompanied by the missing pillars: free opposition campaigning and occasional victories, independent courts checking the government, and equal rights for minorities. Those conditions, together with voting, are what make a democracy real, so they are signs of democracy, not its failure.

23. (C) Rule of law means the law binds everyone, including the government and its leaders, not just the public. The idea that leaders stand above the law contradicts this and points toward dictatorship. Exempting rulers while binding only citizens is the same error. And the law does not switch on only in election years; it applies continuously, which is part of what makes a democracy stable.

24. (B) Judicial independence lets courts rule fairly even against the government, protecting laws and rights from abuse, which is its democratic value. A court that always favours the ruling party is not independent and provides no real check. One that follows the head of government's instructions is controlled, not independent. And merely advising a king describes a system without genuine judicial power, missing the protective role independence supplies.

25. (D) Elections must be free and fair so the outcome reflects the people's true choice; intimidation or rigging empties the vote of meaning even if it happens on time. Treating elections as a mere formality denies their central democratic role. Allowing only the ruling party to contest removes real competition and choice. And deciding the winner in advance is rigging by another name, exactly what free and fair elections are meant to prevent.

26. (D) What a dictatorship lacks but a democracy has is real accountability: rulers must answer to the people and can be voted out in free elections. A capital city exists under any government, so it cannot distinguish the two. The same applies to armed forces defending borders, which dictatorships also maintain. And national symbols like a flag and anthem are present under every kind of government, so only accountability through free elections marks the democratic difference.

27. (C) Rights, an independent court and equality are present here, but with no elections the people cannot choose or remove rulers, so free and fair elections are the missing pillar.

Protected free speech is explicitly guaranteed, so that pillar is present. An independent court that can rule against the government is also present. And equality before the law is guaranteed too. Only the electoral mechanism for choosing and replacing rulers is absent, which is what the question targets.

28. (A) Democracy is majority decision-making constrained by constitutional protection of minority and individual rights, so it is more than counting heads. Letting the majority override every right is exactly what democracy guards against. Letting only the minority decide would not be democracy, since power must ultimately rest with the people broadly. And having no rules limiting any group describes lawlessness, not the rule-bound system democracy actually is.

29. (B) Accountability means rulers must answer to the people who elected them and can be removed by those people through elections. A government free from all questioning is the opposite of accountable. One answerable only to a foreign power ignores its own citizens, again missing accountability. And a government that may overrule the courts at will escapes the legal checks that genuine accountability requires.

30. (C) Equality means each citizen counts equally before the law and in selecting the government, whatever their wealth or birth, which underpins democracy. Giving the wealthy extra votes by property would destroy that equality. Recognising only one religion's followers as full citizens denies equal standing to others. And reserving decisions for a few powerful families is oligarchy, the very inequality democratic equality rejects.

31. (C) Under rule of law, an electoral win never lifts leaders above the law; the constitution binds even a majority government. Saying a majority frees leaders from legal limits is exactly the abuse the constitution prevents. Claiming only courts and never the constitution can limit leaders misstates the system, since courts apply the constitution itself. And an electoral victory does not suspend fundamental rights, which remain guaranteed regardless of who wins.

32. (C) A genuine democracy is marked by free and fair elections together with equality before the law, protected rights and an independent judiciary; these reinforce one another. A large army, long history and single ruling family say nothing about democracy and hint at concentrated power. Regular votes with no rights or independent courts is the elections-only trap that falls short. And rule by religious law with clergy choosing leaders describes a theocracy, not a democracy.

33. (D) When a monarch's role is formal and an elected parliament actually makes and answers for the laws, the country is a constitutional monarchy and, because the people elect the governing parliament, a parliamentary democracy. It is not an absolute monarchy; signing laws ceremonially is not the same as truly wielding power. It is not a dictatorship, since power is elected and accountable, not unchecked. And ceremonial reverence for a queen is unrelated to rule by religious law, so it is not a theocracy.

34. (A) A country can indeed be both a monarchy and a democracy, and the explanation is exactly that in a constitutional monarchy the monarch is largely nominal while an elected parliament governs; so the reason supplies the very mechanism that makes the assertion possible. Claiming the reason fails to explain the assertion misses this direct link. The reason is not false, since constitutional monarchies such as the UK demonstrate it. And the assertion is not false, because real constitutional monarchies are working democracies.

35. (A) The difference lies in who actually exercises power: in Saudi Arabia the king truly rules (absolute monarchy), whereas in the UK the king is nominal and an elected parliament governs (constitutional monarchy and democracy). Claiming both kings rule absolutely is wrong about the UK. Merely having a monarch does not make a country a democracy, so saying both are democracies misses the point. And no monarch is elected; the UK's democratic status comes from its elected parliament, not from any election of the king.

36. (B) The dividing line is who actually exercises power: an absolute monarch really governs, whereas a constitutional monarch is largely nominal while an elected body makes the laws. Saying both are purely ceremonial erases the absolute monarch's genuine power. Claiming the absolute king is elected is wrong, since monarchs inherit in both kinds. And the last option reverses reality, because it is the constitutional monarch, not the absolute one, who lacks real lawmaking power.

37. (D) A king who actually makes laws, commands forces and judges disputes, with no elected check, is an absolute monarchy. It is not a constitutional monarchy, because there the monarch is nominal and an elected parliament governs, the opposite of this hands-on king. It is not a republic, which requires an elected, non-hereditary head of state, not a ruling hereditary king. And it is not a direct democracy, where the people, not a single king, decide issues themselves.

38. (A) A country where a hereditary monarch reigns while an elected parliament governs disproves the idea that any monarchy rules out democracy. It does not disprove that monarchs inherit their position; the UK's monarch did inherit. It does not disprove that parliaments make laws; the UK parliament clearly does. And it does not disprove that democracies hold elections; the UK holds them, so only the king-blocks-democracy claim is refuted.

39. (D) A monarchy is defined by power being inherited within a family, usually by birth. A republic specifically requires an elected, non-hereditary head of state, the opposite of inheritance. Representative democracy chooses leaders by election, not by birth. And an oligarchy concentrates power in a small group that may be wealthy but is not defined by hereditary succession of one family throne, so monarchy is the only fit.

40. (B) The UK is democratic because real governing power lies with an elected parliament while the unelected monarch is merely nominal. The monarch is not secretly

elected; the position is inherited. The monarch does not personally make laws after a vote; parliament makes the laws. And merely having a monarch does not make a country democratic, since absolute monarchies have monarchs yet are not democracies, so it is the elected parliament that does the democratic work.

41. (C) Both can be democracies, but a republic has an elected head of state whereas a constitutional monarchy retains a hereditary monarch as nominal head. The first distractor reverses these, wrongly giving the republic a king and the monarchy an elected head. Saying only the constitutional monarchy can be a democracy is false, since republics are democracies too. And claiming neither holds elections is wrong, because both elect their governing legislatures.

42. (A) Correctly, the legislature makes laws, the executive implements them, and the judiciary settles disputes and ensures laws are followed. The other options scramble these roles, for example handing lawmaking to the judiciary or dispute-settling to the legislature, which misstates each organ's function. And it is wrong that all three only make laws; only the legislature makes laws, while the others enforce and interpret them.

43. (A) Interpreting the law and judging whether an act breaks it is the judicial function, so striking down an unlawful order is judicial work; the executive only carries out laws and is here being checked, not acting. It is not legislative, because the court is applying existing law, not writing a new one. It is not executive, because the court is reviewing the government rather than enforcing its will. And there is no real 'ceremonial' organ among the three; this is substantive judicial action.

44. (B) Debating and passing a new law is the legislative function, the work of the lawmaking body. The executive function is carrying out laws once made, not passing them. The judicial function is interpreting laws and settling disputes, again not passing them. And there is no separate 'electoral' function among the three organs; electing representatives is how the legislature is formed, but lawmaking itself is legislative.

45. (D) Dividing government into legislature, executive and judiciary that work independently prevents any one organ from seizing total control and abusing it, which is why separation of powers safeguards democracy. Letting the executive run the courts would destroy judicial independence, the very danger separation guards against. Concentrating all authority in the legislature also defeats the purpose by removing checks. And it does not remove the need for laws; it organises who makes, enforces and interprets them.

46. (B) Separating power among independent legislature, executive and judiciary lets each check the others, preventing any one leader from dominating. Letting one leader appoint all judges and control lawmaking destroys those checks and concentrates power. Abolishing the courts removes the judicial check entirely. And placing the army over the

legislature and judiciary creates a different concentration of power, again undermining the goal.

47. (B) When a single ruler controls lawmaking, enforcement and judging together, the missing principle is separation of powers, which would keep those organs independent. A national flag is unrelated to how power is divided and exists under any government. Population size says nothing about the separation of functions. And physical geography such as rivers and mountains has nothing to do with whether power is separated, so only the absence of separation of powers fits.

48. (C) The legislature, executive and judiciary are distinct but together operate one state, each bound by the law, which is how separation of powers works in practice. They are not separate countries; they are organs of a single government. Lawmaking belongs to the legislature and judging to the judiciary, so swapping those roles is wrong. And all three are part of the government, not just the executive, so the last option is mistaken.

49. (A) The defining contrast is the executive-legislature relationship: a prime minister is drawn from the legislature and stays only while it has confidence in the government, whereas a president is separately elected and independent of the legislature. Heads of government in these democracies are not hereditary monarchs. The second option swaps the two definitions, inverting the truth. And courts do not appoint the head of government in either system; the executive owes its position to elections or the legislature, not to judges.

50. (B) Whether a democracy is parliamentary or presidential turns on where real executive power sits. In India that power lies with the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers, drawn from and answerable to the legislature, while the President's role is largely nominal. Saying the President governs reverses the actual arrangement. Merely having two top posts does not decide the label; what matters is who wields real power. And the manner of choosing the President does not make the system presidential, since the parliamentary character comes from the executive depending on legislative confidence.

51. (C) Because India is a parliamentary democracy, the executive must keep the legislature's confidence; losing a no-confidence vote forces the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers to resign. The claim that nothing changes treats the system as presidential with a fixed-term head, which India is not. The President is not removed by a no-confidence vote in the government. And the Supreme Court has no role in dissolving itself or electing a government; that is not a judicial function.

52. (D) A head of government removable when the legislature withdraws confidence is the parliamentary model, while a separately elected head serving a fixed term independent of the legislature is the presidential model, so the order is parliamentary then presidential. Reversing them mislabels each. Neither description concerns monarchy, since both involve

elected heads of government, not kings. And theocracy and oligarchy concern religious rule and rule by a few, which match neither description.

53. (B) India and the USA differ in form: the US President is the real head of government in a presidential system, but India's President is largely nominal while the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers, answerable to Parliament, actually govern in a parliamentary system. Treating both Presidents as real heads of government ignores this difference. India does have a Prime Minister, so the claim that the President must run everything is false. And India's President is neither directly elected by all voters nor rules independently, so the comparison to the US presidency does not hold.

54. (A) In a parliamentary democracy the executive comes from the legislature and remains in power only while it keeps the legislature's confidence. A separately elected, irremovable executive describes a presidential system instead. The executive and legislature are not one person; they are distinct bodies linked by a confidence relationship. And the executive does not control or abolish the legislature at will, which would destroy the accountability that defines the parliamentary form.

55. (D) The chapter's conclusion is that, for all its imperfections, democracy is the most widely adopted form of government in the world today. Calling it the rarest contradicts how many countries use it. Saying no country actually uses it is plainly false. And equating it with dictatorship ignores the differences in accountability, rights and elections that the chapter stresses throughout.

56. (C) These examples illustrate that the idea of people choosing their rulers is ancient and appeared across civilisations such as the Vajji in India and the republics of Greece and Rome. Saying democracy was invented in the twenty-first century ignores this long history. Claiming only one civilisation ever tried self-rule contradicts the very point of listing several. And insisting elections were impossible before modern times is refuted by ancient inscriptions and republics.

57. (C) The Lichchhavis were part of the Vajji confederation, an early example of leaders being chosen rather than simply inheriting power, which is the point it illustrates. The Mauryan Magadha empire was a monarchy of inherited kings, not the Vajji confederation. The Cholas were a southern kingdom associated with the Uttaramerur election records but not with the Lichchhavi clan. And the Kushanas were a northwestern empire unrelated to the Vajji, so only the Vajji is correct.

58. (B) The Uttaramerur inscriptions are prized as evidence that organised elections to choose local representatives existed in early India. They directly contradict the claim that India held no elections before modern times. They also disprove the notion that only hereditary kings ever held power, since they record elected representation. And they show elections were not unique to Greece, since India practised them too.

59. (A) What truly separates one type of government from another is who holds power and how the government is formed and kept accountable, the core theme of the chapter. Land area does not determine the kind of government; large and small countries can be democracies or dictatorships. Army size likewise says nothing about how power is held or chosen. And a country's age is unrelated to whether its rulers are selected by and answerable to the people, so only the question of power and accountability fits.

60. (A) A genuine democracy rests on several pillars together: free elections, an independent judiciary, rule of law and protected freedoms such as the right to criticise. Country P meets these, since its courts can rule against the government and its critics are safe, so it is the more accurate democracy. Country Q fails, because controlling the judges, jailing critics and banning rivals strips away those pillars even while a vote is staged, so elections alone are not the complete test. The two are not equal merely because both hold elections, since the surrounding conditions differ sharply. And democracy does not forbid political parties; organised parties are a normal part of it, so 'neither' is wrong.